



HTML Form Validation Cheat Sheet (No JavaScript)

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This cheat sheet helps you quickly reference the most important HTML attributes and patterns for validating forms in the browser, no JavaScript required! Use these to improve user experience and data quality.



Tip

Complete Dev Roadmap with SaaS Boilerplate at
thedevspace.io

1. Required Fields

Make a field mandatory.

```
1 <input type="text" name="username" required />
```

- `required` : Field must be filled out before submitting.

2. Input Types

Use semantic input types for built-in validation.

```
1 <input type="email" name="email" required  
  placeholder="you@example.com" />  
2 <!-- Must be a valid email -->  
3 <input type="number" name="age" min="1" max="120"  
  step="1" required />  
4 <!-- Only numbers, min/max/step -->  
5 <input type="url" name="website"  
  placeholder="https://example.com" />  
6 <!-- Must be a valid URL -->  
7 <input  
8   type="tel"  
9   name="phone"  
10  pattern="[0-9]{3}-[0-9]{3}-[0-9]{4}"  
11  placeholder="123-456-7890" />  
12 <!-- Phone with pattern -->
```

- `type="email"` : Must be a valid email.
- `type="url"` : Must be a valid URL.
- `type="number"` : Only numbers allowed, can set `min` and `max` .
- `type="tel"` : For phone numbers, use `pattern` for format.
- `type="password"` : Use `minlength` / `maxlength` for length.

3. Pattern Attribute

Validate input with a regular expression.

```
1 <input type="text" name="zip" pattern="[0-9]{5}"  
  title="5 digit ZIP code" />
```

- **pattern** : Regex for allowed input.
- **title** : Custom error message shown on invalid input.

4. Length & Value Constraints

Limit input length or value.

```
1 <input  
2   type="text"  
3   name="nickname"  
4   minlength="3"  
5   maxlength="10"  
6   required  
7   placeholder="3-10 chars" />  
8 <input type="number" name="score" min="0" max="100"  
  step="5" />  
9 <!-- Only multiples of 5 -->
```

- **minlength** / **maxlength** : Character limits for text.
- **min** / **max** : Value limits for numbers.
- **step** : Allowed increments for numbers.

5. Select, Checkbox, and Radio Validation

Require a selection.

```
1 <select name="country" required>
2   <option value="">Select country</option>
3   <option value="us">USA</option>
4   <option value="ca">Canada</option>
5 </select>
6
7 <input type="checkbox" name="agree" required /> I
  agree to terms
8
9 <input type="radio" name="gender" value="male"
  required /> Male
10 <input type="radio" name="gender" value="female"
    required /> Female
```

- `required` on `<select>`, `<checkbox>`, or `<radio>` ensures a choice is made.

6. Disabling Native Validation

Turn off browser validation (for custom JS validation).

```
1 <form novalidate>
2   <!-- custom validation here -->
3 </form>
```

- `novalidate` : Disables built-in validation for the form.

7. Autofocus, Autocomplete, and Placeholder

Enhance usability and accessibility.

```
1 <input
2   type="text"
3   name="username"
4   autofocus
5   autocomplete="username"
6   placeholder="Enter your username" />
```

- **autofocus** : Focus field on page load.
- **autocomplete** : Suggest previously entered values.
- **placeholder** : Show hint text.